

Legal Affairs Request Management Platform

Developer Onboarding Guide

Intern Edition

Project

Legal Affairs Request Management Platform

Purpose

Developer onboarding and project overview

Audience

Software Engineering Interns

Version

1.0

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1. Project Overview

What is the Legal Affairs Request Management Platform?

The Legal Affairs Request Management Platform is a web application designed to help the university manage, classify, review, track, and monitor legal requests handled by the Legal Affairs department.

Legal Affairs receives a wide range of requests from different university departments, including contract reviews, legal advice, research agreements, student agreements, HR-related legal matters, procurement reviews, administrative approvals, committee-related cases, and external collaboration agreements.

Currently, these requests may come through emails, shared documents, manual trackers, or direct communication. This can make it difficult to monitor workload, identify urgent matters, track response time, maintain institutional knowledge, and ensure consistency across legal reviews.

The platform provides a centralized system where all legal requests can be submitted, categorized, assigned, reviewed, tracked, and archived.

The system may also include AI-assisted capabilities to support Legal Affairs by extracting key information from documents, suggesting request categories, identifying missing clauses, highlighting potential risks, recommending relevant templates, and helping prepare first-draft summaries or review notes.

However, the AI component is only a support tool. Final review, approval, and legal decisions remain the responsibility of the Legal Affairs team.

2. Project Objective

The Legal Affairs Request Management Platform aims to:

- Centralize all legal requests received by Legal Affairs.
 - Classify requests by type, priority, department, and risk level.
 - Track request status from submission to closure.
 - Support legal review of contracts, agreements, letters, and institutional documents.
 - Maintain a searchable history of legal opinions, reviewed agreements, and previous decisions.
 - Improve turnaround time and transparency.
 - Provide dashboards showing workload, request volume, processing time, and pending actions.
 - Support AI-assisted document review while preserving human legal oversight.
 - Reduce repetitive manual work through templates, checklists, and automated summaries.
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3. Legal Request Categories

Instead of student segments, this platform uses legal request categories. These categories help determine routing, workflow, priority, and the type of legal review required.

Category	Description	Examples	Typical Actions
LEG-A Legal Advice / Opinion	Requests requiring legal interpretation, advice, or formal opinion.	HR matters, institutional legal questions, internal policy interpretation, payment-related legal clarification.	Assign legal reviewer, review background documents, draft opinion, approve response, archive decision.
LEG-B Contract Review	Requests to review contracts, MoUs, NDAs, service agreements, procurement contracts, sponsorships, or vendor agreements.	MoU with external partner, NDA, service agreement, procurement contract, conference agreement.	Extract clauses, check missing terms, identify risks, suggest revisions, track negotiation status.
LEG-C Research Agreements	Legal review of research-related contracts and collaboration agreements.	Sponsored research, data-sharing agreements, research collaboration agreements, AI research partnerships, university-to-university agreements.	Check IP, confidentiality, publication rights, data usage, funding terms, liability, ethics-related clauses.
LEG-D Student Agreements	Agreements or legal matters involving students, internships, exchange, training, financial obligations, or academic-related commitments.	Internship agreement, student exchange agreement, payment guideline, student commitment agreement.	Review student obligations, university responsibilities, insurance, liability, payment terms, approvals.
LEG-E Committee / Investigation / Disciplinary Matters	Requests linked to investigations, disciplinary committees, complaints, appeals, or governance cases.	Student disciplinary matter, plagiarism case, investigation committee, invalid contract complaint.	Register case, restrict access, track evidence, support committee workflow, maintain confidential record.
LEG-F Administrative Legal Work	Administrative legal support requests.	Power of attorney, visa-related documents, letters, certificates, board documents, payment-related requests.	Review document, confirm authority, prepare legal note, route for approval, archive final version.

Category	Description	Examples	Typical Actions
LEG-G Legal Operations / Reporting	Internal Legal Affairs tracking, reporting, and knowledge management.	Request dashboard, workload summary, template library, legal knowledge base.	Generate reports, monitor KPIs, update templates, maintain legal repository.

4. Data Sources

The platform does not replace official university systems. It retrieves or stores only the information required to manage the legal request lifecycle.

Source	Data Retrieved
Legal Affairs Email / Intake Form	Incoming legal requests, requester details, attachments, deadlines, priority, department.
Document Repository	Contracts, MoUs, NDAs, research agreements, student agreements, legal letters, previous reviewed versions.
Legal Knowledge Base	Previous legal opinions, approved clauses, templates, standard positions, historical decisions.
HR System	Employee-related legal requests, disciplinary matters, employment-related documents, if approved for integration.
Procurement System	Vendor contracts, purchase-related agreements, service agreements, procurement documents.
Research Office System	Research agreements, sponsored project documents, grant-related terms, collaboration agreements.
Student Affairs System	Student agreements, disciplinary cases, internship agreements, student-related legal matters.
Finance System	Payment-related legal requests, guarantees, bond agreements, refund cases, financial obligations.

Integration Notes

- Version 1 may start with manual upload and request intake forms.
- Later versions can integrate with email, document repositories, HR, procurement, research, student affairs, and finance systems.
- Sensitive legal documents must be access-controlled.
- All actions should be logged for audit and accountability.
- AI-generated outputs must be clearly marked as draft suggestions.

5. Core Features

Version 1 of the platform includes the following modules.

5.1 Legal Request Management

The Legal Request Management module allows users to submit, view, assign, and track legal requests.

Main functions:

- Create a new legal request.
- Upload supporting documents.
- Select request type.
- Add requester, department, priority, deadline, and description.
- Assign the request to a Legal Affairs reviewer.
- Track request status.
- Maintain request history.
- Store final response and approved documents.

Typical request statuses:

- New
 - Under Review
 - Waiting for More Information
 - Assigned to Legal Reviewer
 - Draft Response Prepared
 - Sent for Internal Approval
 - Returned for Revision
 - Approved
 - Closed
 - Archived
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5.2 Document Intake and Classification

The platform should support document upload and automatic classification.

Supported document types may include:

- Contracts
- MoUs
- NDAs
- Research agreements
- Student agreements

- HR documents
- Procurement documents
- Legal letters
- Committee documents
- Payment-related documents

The AI assistant may help identify:

- Document type
 - Parties involved
 - Effective date
 - Expiry date
 - Governing law
 - Key obligations
 - Payment terms
 - Confidentiality clauses
 - IP clauses
 - Termination clauses
 - Missing information
 - Potential risk areas
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5.3 AI-Assisted Legal Review Engine

The AI Legal Review Engine assists the Legal Affairs team by analyzing submitted documents and generating structured review support.

The engine may:

- Suggest request category.
- Extract key clauses.
- Identify missing or unusual clauses.
- Compare the document against university-approved templates.
- Highlight high-risk terms.
- Summarize obligations for the university.
- Generate a first-draft review note.
- Suggest questions to send back to the requester.
- Recommend relevant previous legal opinions or similar reviewed agreements.

Important: The AI engine does not make final legal decisions. All outputs must be reviewed and approved by Legal Affairs.

5.4 Contract and Agreement Review

This module supports structured review of contracts and agreements.

Main functions:

- Upload contract or agreement.
- Extract metadata.
- Compare against standard checklist.
- Identify missing clauses.
- Highlight risky language.
- Record reviewer comments.
- Track negotiation versions.
- Store approved final version.
- Link the agreement to related department, project, partner, or requester.

Review checklist examples:

- Parties correctly identified.
- Scope clearly defined.
- Payment terms included.
- Term and termination clauses included.
- Confidentiality clause included.
- Data protection clause included, if relevant.
- Intellectual property clause included, if relevant.
- Liability and indemnity reviewed.
- Governing law and jurisdiction reviewed.
- Signature authority confirmed.
- Internal approvals obtained.

5.5 Legal Opinion and Knowledge Base

This module allows Legal Affairs to store and reuse previous legal opinions and institutional decisions.

Main functions:

- Store final legal opinions.
- Tag opinions by topic, department, risk type, and request category.
- Search previous cases.
- Link similar requests.
- Maintain approved templates and standard clauses.
- Provide AI-assisted retrieval of relevant past opinions.

Example knowledge base categories:

- HR legal opinions
- Procurement legal opinions
- Research agreement positions
- Student-related matters
- Data sharing and confidentiality

- IP and publication rights
 - Payment and financial obligations
 - Governance and committee cases
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5.6 Workflow and Approval Management

Some legal requests require internal approvals before closure.

The platform should support configurable workflows depending on request type.

Examples:

- Contract review may require Legal Affairs approval and department confirmation.
- Research agreement may require Research Office, PI, Legal Affairs, and Finance review.
- Student agreement may require Student Affairs and Legal Affairs review.
- HR legal matter may require HR and Legal Affairs review.
- Procurement contract may require Procurement, Finance, and Legal Affairs review.

Workflow features:

- Assign reviewers.
 - Add approvers.
 - Request clarification.
 - Track pending approvals.
 - Send reminders.
 - Maintain approval history.
 - Record final decision.
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5.7 Dashboard and Reporting

The dashboard provides management visibility over Legal Affairs workload and performance.

Dashboard indicators may include:

- Total number of legal requests.
- Requests by category.
- Requests by department.
- Pending requests.
- Overdue requests.
- Average turnaround time.
- High-risk requests.
- Contracts under review.
- Research agreements under review.
- Student agreements under review.

- Requests waiting for requester input.
- Closed requests per month.

Reports may support:

- Weekly Legal Affairs activity summary.
- Monthly workload report.
- Request aging report.
- Department-wise request volume.
- Common legal risk themes.
- Contract review turnaround time.

5.8 Notifications and Communication

The platform should support communication between Legal Affairs and requesters.

Notification examples:

- Request received.
- Request assigned.
- Additional information required.
- Review completed.
- Approval required.
- Request overdue.
- Request closed.
- Document revision requested.

Communication should be linked to the request record to avoid losing context across emails or separate messages.

5.9 Audit Log and Access Control

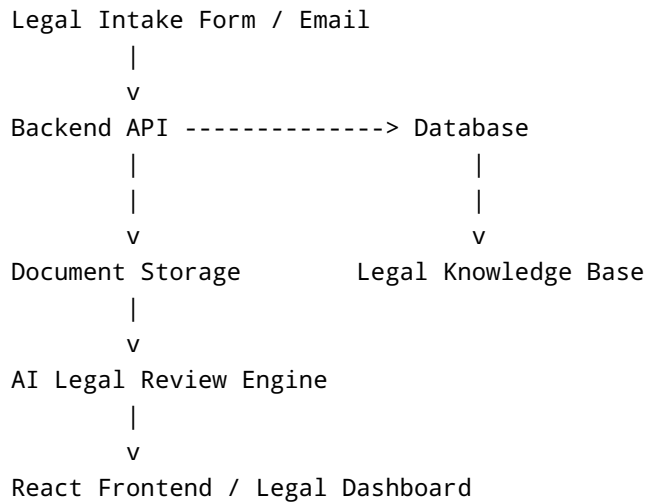
Legal requests may contain confidential information. The platform must include strong access control and audit logging.

Main requirements:

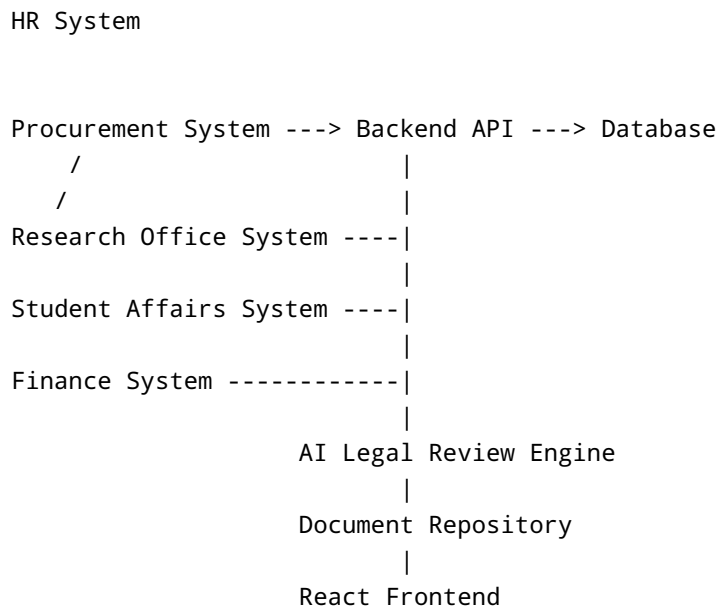
- Role-based access control.
- Restricted access for disciplinary and investigation cases.
- Audit log for every action.
- Record who viewed, edited, downloaded, approved, or closed a request.
- Maintain version history of documents.
- Separate draft AI output from approved legal output.
- Ensure only authorized users can access sensitive matters.

6. System Architecture

The initial architecture may look as follows:



Possible future integration architecture:



7. User Roles

Role	Description	Main Permissions
Requester	University staff member submitting a legal request.	Submit request, upload documents, respond to clarification, view own requests.
Legal Reviewer	Legal Affairs staff member reviewing the request.	Review documents, add comments, classify risk, prepare response, request information.
Legal Manager	Senior Legal Affairs user responsible for approval and oversight.	Assign reviewers, approve responses, monitor dashboard, close or escalate requests.
Department Approver	Department representative involved in the workflow.	Review department-specific content, approve or comment.
Admin User	System administrator.	Manage users, roles, categories, templates, and configuration.
AI Assistant	System component supporting classification, extraction, and review.	Generate draft analysis, summarize documents, suggest risks, retrieve similar cases.

8. Main Workflow

8.1 Request Submission

1. Requester submits a legal request through the platform.
2. Requester selects the request type or leaves it for classification.
3. Requester uploads supporting documents.
4. System creates a request ID.
5. System sends confirmation to the requester.

8.2 Classification and Assignment

1. System suggests the legal request category.
2. Legal Affairs confirms or updates the category.
3. Request is assigned to a legal reviewer.
4. Priority and deadline are confirmed.

8.3 Document Review

1. AI engine extracts key information from the document.
2. AI engine generates a draft review summary.

3. Legal reviewer checks the document manually.
4. Legal reviewer adds comments, risks, and required changes.
5. Reviewer may request additional information from the requester.

8.4 Approval and Response

1. Legal reviewer prepares the final legal response or review note.
2. Legal manager reviews and approves, if required.
3. Response is shared with the requester.
4. Final documents are uploaded and stored.

8.5 Closure and Archiving

1. Request is marked as completed.
2. Final response and documents are archived.
3. Request metadata is stored for reporting.
4. Relevant knowledge may be added to the legal knowledge base.

9. AI Assistance Scope

The AI assistant can support the Legal Affairs team in the following areas:

- Classifying requests.
- Summarizing legal documents.
- Extracting key clauses.
- Identifying missing clauses.
- Comparing documents with approved templates.
- Highlighting potential legal risks.
- Suggesting review checklists.
- Recommending similar past cases.
- Drafting internal review notes.
- Preparing first-draft responses.

The AI assistant must not:

- Provide final legal approval.
 - Replace Legal Affairs judgment.
 - Send legal responses without human review.
 - Modify official documents without reviewer approval.
 - Make binding institutional decisions.
 - Expose confidential documents to unauthorized users.
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10. Notes for Developers

Developers working on this project should keep the following principles in mind:

- Legal documents are highly confidential.
 - Access control is a core requirement, not an optional feature.
 - Every important action must be logged.
 - AI outputs should always be treated as draft suggestions.
 - The system should clearly separate uploaded documents, AI summaries, legal reviewer comments, and final approved responses.
 - The platform should support future integration with university systems.
 - The first version can start with manual upload, request tracking, document review, and dashboarding.
 - The system should be modular so that AI review, workflow approvals, and integrations can be added progressively.
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Suggested Version 1 Scope

Version 1 should focus on the following minimum viable product:

1. Legal request intake form.
 2. Request categorization.
 3. Document upload.
 4. Request assignment.
 5. Status tracking.
 6. Reviewer comments.
 7. Basic AI document summary.
 8. Contract review checklist.
 9. Dashboard for request volume and pending items.
 10. Audit log and role-based access control.
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Suggested Future Enhancements

Future versions may include:

- Integration with email inbox.
- Integration with HR, procurement, research, finance, and student affairs systems.
- Advanced AI clause comparison.
- Legal template recommendation.
- Automated deadline reminders.
- Full approval workflow engine.
- Digital signature integration.

- Advanced analytics on legal risks and recurring issues.
 - Legal knowledge graph linking requests, clauses, departments, partners, and previous opinions.
 - Multi-language legal document support.
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Summary

The Legal Affairs Request Management Platform is intended to improve how legal requests are received, reviewed, tracked, and reported across the university.

It centralizes Legal Affairs work, supports structured contract and agreement review, improves visibility over legal workload, and provides AI-assisted tools to reduce repetitive manual effort.

The platform does not replace Legal Affairs. Instead, it supports the Legal Affairs team by improving organization, consistency, response time, and institutional legal knowledge management.